

# Give Wings to Your Career With Aerospace

Aerospace is one of the most technologically advanced branches of engineering. Though emerging slowly in India, it promises a career with a number of exciting job opportunities



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**D**o you enjoy solving problems and puzzles? Are you interested in knowing what makes things work? Do you have an inquisitive mind? Are you a team player? If your answer is yes to most of these questions, why not reach for the sky and plan a career in aerospace! A high-tech and fast-changing branch of engineering, aerospace is regarded as one of the toughest fields in the world that offers not only a huge scope for innovation and development but also opportunities for high job satisfaction and excellent compensation.

## The field

Aerospace engineering deals with the design, construction, development, testing and manufacture of aircrafts, spacecrafts, missiles, military planes, space shuttles, satellites and hovercrafts—in other words, vehicles/systems that are meant for atmospheric and space environments. Aerospace

engineers work within a team of other engineers to develop new technologies for use in aviation, defence systems and space exploration, often specialising in such areas as structural design, guidance, navigation and control, instrumentation and communication, or production methods. Those who work with aircrafts are called aeronautical engineers, while aerospace engineers working with the craft that operates outside of the earth's atmosphere are known as astronautical engineers.

Let's delve a little deeper into what a career in aerospace and aeronautics could mean for you and what kind of growth in remuneration as well as roles and responsibilities you can expect from this field.

## Why aerospace?

"Aerospace engineering is a growing field and the current trend indicates that it is bound to grow very rapidly in the coming days. There is a huge scope of innovation and development in this field. The growth prospects appear to be quite high," opines K.P. Sinhamahapatra, professor and head of aerospace engineering department at IIT Kharagpur.

The US continues to lead the world aerospace market, with its most profitable sector being manufacturing. According to the Aerospace Industries Association (AIA), the number of production job opportunities in the manufacturing sector there has increased significantly last year and will continue to do so in years to come.

"Though aerospace is one of the highest paying fields in the US currently, in India, this field is emerging slowly," Sinhamahapatra adds.

Dr P. Sriram, professor and head, department of aerospace engineering, IIT Madras, shares, "With the overall growth in the economy, air travel is experiencing a boom and this will be fed by more aviation infrastructure including airports, aircraft and other related items. Aircraft fleet planning and maintenance will also become a major

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